

Diagnose the Objection

Eight conditions • Steps 9–11 • Internal Training Use Only

What This Is — And Why It's Different

Every sales system teaches one answer for every objection — acknowledge, reassure, overcome. Same medicine, every patient. We don't do that, because two homeowners can say the **exact same words** and need opposite treatments. "I need to think about it" from a thirty-year household rule and "I need to think about it" from someone burned by their last contractor are different problems — and answering both the same way loses one of them.

So we work like a doctor: nobody gets a prescription from "my stomach hurts." First we find out what's actually wrong. **Then** we treat it. That's the whole system: diagnose first, answer second.

The Four Steps

STEP	THE QUESTION	WHAT IT MEANS
1. SYMPTOM	What did they say?	Their words. Never treated — only heard.
2. DIG	What's underneath it?	The three shovels — mirror, question, label — until it's clear.
3. DIAGNOSE	Which of the eight is it?	Named silently, never spoken. If you'd be guessing — back to Step 2.
4. PLAY	What do I run?	The pre-wired play for that diagnosis. Run it, don't improvise.

The test: if you'd be guessing between conditions, you're still at the symptom — keep digging. "We need three estimates" could be a Rule, a Value doubt, or a Trust wound: same words, three treatments. The diagnosis stays in your head, never spoken.

The Three Tools — How You Dig

TOOL	WHAT YOU SAY	WHEN YOU USE IT
1. MIRROR	<i>Repeat their last few words back as a question. "Think about it?" — then 4 seconds of silence.</i>	You know nothing yet. Always your first move — it makes them explain themselves. Whoever talks first loses.
2. QUESTION	<i>"How do you mean?" — calm, then silence again.</i>	The mirror came back vague. You heard words but still can't tell what's underneath.
3. LABEL	<i>"It sounds like..." — never "I think."</i>	They revealed something clear and you're confirming it. If you can't finish the sentence without guessing, you haven't earned it — mirror instead.

When the condition has a name — STOP DIGGING. Put the tools down and run the play. Digging past a named condition talks customers out of decisions.

The Eight Conditions

CONDITION	SOUNDS LIKE	THE PLAY
MONEY		
1. Value	<i>"Thirty-four is crazy for a roof." The number offends them; cash never comes up.</i>	Cost vs. Value (the 64% move) → cinch their discovery answers → the Triangle. Never finance a price they don't believe.
2. Affordability	<i>"We don't have that kind of money sitting in the bank." No argument with the number.</i>	GoodLeap — show the monthly from the live screen. Don't re-sell value they already agree with.
3. Timing	<i>A reason + a timeline. Money-timing: "Bonus hits in October." Logistics-timing: "Not while the kitchen's torn up."</i>	Conditional commitment first. Money → bridge with GoodLeap. Logistics → schedule-and-lock: book now for the later date, lock today's pricing.
4. Comparison	<i>A specific bid in a drawer: "Another company said twenty-six."</i>	Same-price question → their reasons → the Triangle → the guarantee. Never touch the price.
5. Structure	<i>"\$580 a month is more than we can take on." The total is fine; the payment shape pinches.</i>	Isolate monthly vs. down → their number → conditional commitment → manager call. Structure moves; the total never does.
NON-MONEY		
6. The Rule	<i>A household policy, older than you: "We never sign the same day. Thirty years."</i>	Honor it, never argue it. Label the rule → picture exit → cinch the Safe Space close → "Where did you land?"
7. The Outside Voice	<i>A trusted person in the decision. Senior + family, trade relative, or first-timer citing dad.</i>	One play, three doors: senior → invite the family IN. Trade family → concede price, win on accountability. First-timer → ownership question, route back to money.
8. Trust	<i>A personal wound: "My neighbor got screwed by a roofer." Emotion attached.</i>	Release pressure, never apply it. Label the fear → let the structure reassure: escrow, Directorii, the guarantee. Never say "trust me."

Every Play, One Ending

PRICE → re-close → T.O. chain. Full price is the only price a rep quotes; relief comes from the manager. And if the treatment gets refused — the diagnosis was wrong. Re-diagnose, don't push harder.

New Era Roofs • Internal Training • Replaces "Diagnose the Money"